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1 Math

1.1 Vectors

$$a(\bar{A} + \bar{B}) = a\bar{A} + a\bar{B}$$

$$\bar{A} \cdot \bar{B} = |\bar{A}||\bar{B}|\cos(\theta) \quad (1.1)$$

$$\bar{A} \times \bar{B} = |\bar{A}||\bar{B}|\sin(\theta)\hat{n} \quad (1.4)$$

$$(\bar{A} \times \bar{B}) = -(\bar{B} \times \bar{A}) \quad (1.6)$$

$$\bar{A} \cdot (\bar{B} \times \bar{C}) = \bar{B} \cdot (\bar{C} \times \bar{A}) = \bar{C} \cdot (\bar{A} \times \bar{B}) \quad (1.15)$$

$$\bar{A} \times (\bar{B} \times \bar{C}) = \bar{B}(\bar{A} \cdot \bar{C}) - \bar{C}(\bar{A} \cdot \bar{B}) \quad (1.17)$$

$$(\bar{A} \times \bar{B}) \cdot (\bar{C} \times \bar{D}) = (\bar{A} \cdot \bar{C})(\bar{B} \cdot \bar{D}) - (\bar{A} \cdot \bar{D})(\bar{B} \cdot \bar{C})$$

$$\bar{A} \times [\bar{B} \times (\bar{C} \times \bar{D})] = \bar{B}[\bar{A} \cdot (\bar{C} \times \bar{D})] - (\bar{A} \cdot \bar{B})(\bar{C} \cdot \bar{D}) \quad (1.18)$$

1.2 Calculus

$$dT = \left(\frac{\partial T}{\partial x} \hat{x} + \frac{\partial T}{\partial y} \hat{y} + \frac{\partial T}{\partial z} \hat{z} \right) \cdot (dx\hat{x} + dy\hat{y} + dz\hat{z})$$

$$= (\nabla T) \cdot d\vec{l}, \quad (1.35)$$

where the gradient (∇) is an operator:

$$\nabla = \hat{x} \frac{\partial}{\partial x} + \hat{y} \frac{\partial}{\partial y} + \hat{z} \frac{\partial}{\partial z}. \quad (1.39)$$

The gradient is used to calculate the divergence of a vector with:

$$\nabla \cdot \bar{v} = \frac{\partial v_x}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial v_y}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v_z}{\partial z}, \quad (1.40)$$

and the curl with:

$$\nabla \times \bar{v} = \begin{vmatrix} \hat{x} & \hat{y} & \hat{z} \\ \frac{\partial}{\partial x} & \frac{\partial}{\partial y} & \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \\ v_x & v_y & v_z \end{vmatrix}$$

$$= \left(\frac{\partial v_z}{\partial y} - \frac{\partial v_y}{\partial z} \right) \hat{x} + \left(\frac{\partial v_x}{\partial z} - \frac{\partial v_z}{\partial x} \right) \hat{y} + \left(\frac{\partial v_y}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial v_x}{\partial y} \right) \hat{z}. \quad (1.41)$$

The product rules for the gradient are:

$$\nabla(fg) = f\nabla g + g\nabla f$$

$$\nabla(\bar{A} \cdot \bar{B}) = \bar{A} \times (\nabla \times \bar{B}) + \bar{B} \times (\nabla \times \bar{A}) + (\bar{A} \cdot \nabla)\bar{B} + (\bar{B} \cdot \nabla)\bar{A}$$

$$\nabla \cdot (f\bar{A}) = f(\nabla \cdot \bar{A}) + \bar{A} \cdot (\nabla f)$$

$$\nabla \cdot (\bar{A} \times \bar{B}) = \bar{B} \cdot (\nabla \times \bar{A}) - \bar{A} \cdot (\nabla \times \bar{B})$$

$$\nabla \times (f\bar{A}) = f(\nabla \times \bar{A}) + \nabla f \times \bar{A}$$

$$\nabla \times (\bar{A} \times \bar{B}) = \bar{A}(\nabla \cdot \bar{B}) - \bar{B}(\nabla \cdot \bar{A}) + (\bar{B} \cdot \nabla)\bar{A} - (\bar{A} \cdot \nabla)\bar{B}$$

When we use the gradient to make a second derivative we get the Laplacian:

$$\nabla(\nabla T) = \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 T}{\partial z^2}, \quad (1.42)$$

and the laplacian of a vector:

$$\nabla^2 \bar{v} = (\nabla^2 v_x) \hat{x} + (\nabla^2 v_y) \hat{y} + (\nabla^2 v_z) \hat{z}. \quad (1.43)$$

We also have the following identities:

$$\nabla \times (\nabla T) = 0 \quad (1.45)$$

$$\nabla \cdot (\nabla \times \bar{v}) = 0 \quad (1.46)$$

$$\nabla \times (\nabla \times \bar{v}) = \nabla(\nabla \cdot \bar{A}) - \nabla^2 \bar{A}. \quad (1.47)$$

1.3 Fundamental theorem of calculus

Gradient:

$$\int_a^{\bar{b}} (\nabla T) \cdot d\bar{l} = T(\bar{b}) - T(\bar{a}) \quad (1.55)$$

Divergence:

$$\int_V (\nabla \cdot \bar{v}) dV = \oint_S \bar{v} \cdot d\bar{a} \quad (1.56)$$

Curl:

$$\int_S (\nabla \times \bar{v}) \cdot d\bar{a} = \oint_P \bar{v} \cdot d\bar{l} \quad (1.57)$$

2 Electrostatics

2.1 Electric field

The force on a test charge (Q) from a single point charge (q), a distance $\bar{r}$ away, is calculated by Coulomb's law:

$$\bar{F} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{qQ}{\bar{r}^2} \hat{r}, \quad (2.1)$$

where $\epsilon_0 = 8.85 \cdot 10^{-12} \frac{C^2}{N \cdot m^2}$ is the permittivity of free space.

If we have several point charges, at different distances from Q , we have an electric field:

$$\bar{F} = Q\bar{E}, \quad (2.3)$$

$$\bar{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \sum_i \frac{q_i}{\bar{r}_i^2} \hat{r}_i. \quad (2.4)$$

If we have a continuous charge distribution, we can calculate the electric field by:

$$\bar{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \int \frac{1}{r^2} \hat{r} dq, \quad (2.5)$$

where dq is the charge in a small element, be it line charge ($dq = \lambda dl$), area charge ($dq = \sigma da$) or volume charge ($dq = \rho d\tau$).

Special cases:

Field of infinite length wire:

$$E = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{2\lambda}{z}$$

Field of infinite plane:

$$\bar{E} = \frac{\sigma}{2\epsilon_0} \hat{a}$$

Field outside a uniformly charged sphere with total charge q , $r > R$:

$$\bar{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{q}{r^2} \hat{r}$$

2.2 Divergence and Curl

Field lines are imaginary lines used to represent the direction and strength of a field, such as an electric field. They start on positive charges and end on negative charges. The density of these lines indicates the field's strength; closer lines mean a stronger field.

Flux refers to the quantity of a field passing through a given surface. For an electric field, it is the product of the electric field strength and the area through which the field lines pass, considering the angle between the field lines and the surface.

$$\Phi = \int_S \bar{E} \cdot d\bar{a} \quad (2.11)$$

Gauss's law states that the total electric flux through a closed surface is proportional to the charge enclosed within that surface.

$$\oint \bar{E} \cdot d\bar{a} = \frac{Q_{\text{enc}}}{\epsilon_0}, \quad (2.13)$$

where Q_{enc} is the charge enclosed by the surface. It can be rewritten with the divergence theorem, when $Q_{\text{enc}} = \int_V \rho d\tau$:

$$\nabla \cdot \bar{E} = \frac{\rho}{\epsilon_0}. \quad (2.14)$$

To calculate the curl of the electric field we see that:

$$\int_{\bar{a}}^{\bar{b}} \bar{E} \cdot d\bar{l} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \left(\frac{q}{r_a} - \frac{q}{r_b} \right), \quad (2.18)$$

which on a closed interval gives us:

$$\oint \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{l} = 0, \quad (2.19)$$

$$\nabla \times \vec{E} = \vec{0}. \quad (2.20)$$

2.3 Electric potential

Since we have $\oint \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{l}$, it must be independent of the path taken, and therefore we can calculate the potential of a point as:

$$V(\vec{r}) = - \int_{\vec{O}}^{\vec{r}} \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{l}, \quad (2.21)$$

and the electric potential difference between two points as:

$$V(\vec{b}) - V(\vec{a}) = - \int_{\vec{a}}^{\vec{b}} \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{l}, \quad (2.22)$$

$$\Rightarrow \vec{E} = -\nabla V. \quad (2.23)$$

Poisson's equation:

$$\nabla^2 V = -\frac{\rho}{\epsilon_0}, \quad (2.24)$$

which gives us a way to calculate the potential from the charge distribution:

For a collection of point charges:

$$V(\vec{r}) = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{q_i}{r_i}, \quad (2.27)$$

For a continuous charge distribution:

$$V(\vec{r}) = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \int \frac{1}{r} dq, \quad (2.28)$$

For a volume charge distribution:

$$V(\vec{r}) = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \int \frac{\rho(\vec{r}')}{r} d\tau'. \quad (2.29)$$

Special cases:

Potential of infinite length wire:

$$V = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \lambda \ln \left(\frac{b}{a} \right)$$

Potential of infinite plane:

$$V = \frac{\sigma}{2\epsilon_0} z$$

Potential of spherical shell:

$$V = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{q}{r} & r > R \\ \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{q}{R} & r < R \end{cases}$$

Figure (2.35) shows the way to go between electric field, electric potential and volume charge:

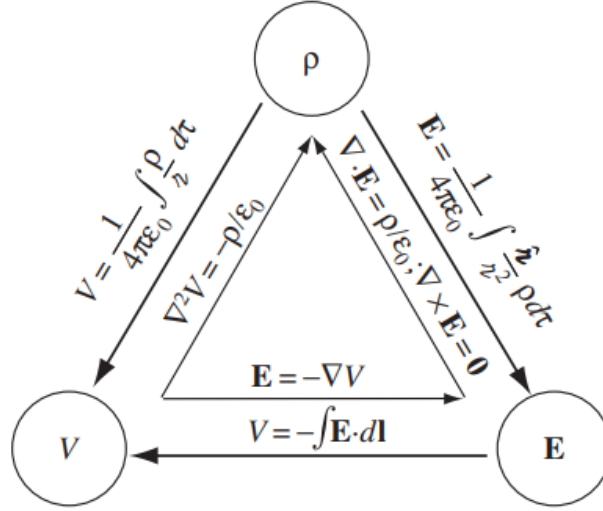


FIGURE 2.35

2.4 Work and Energy

If you want to move a test charge (Q) from point $\bar{a}$ to point $\bar{b}$, you have to do work against the electric field. The work done is the potential difference between the two points:

$$W = Q [V(\bar{b}) - V(\bar{a})]. \quad (2.38)$$

So if you want to move the point from infinity to a point $\bar{r}$, and you have the reference point in infinity:

$$W = QV(\bar{r}). \quad (2.39)$$

The work to move a collection of charges is:

$$W = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j>i}^n \frac{q_i q_j}{r_{ij}}, \quad (2.40)$$

$$= \frac{1}{8\pi\epsilon_0} \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j \neq i}^n \frac{q_i q_j}{r_{ij}}, \quad (2.41)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^n q_i V(\bar{r}_i). \quad (2.42)$$

For continuous charge distributions:

$$W = \frac{1}{2} \int V dq, \quad (2.43)$$

where again, dq is the charge in a small element, be it line charge ($dq = \lambda dl$), area charge ($dq = \sigma da$) or volume charge ($dq = \rho d\tau$).

If we take (2.43) for volume over all space, we get:

$$W = \frac{\epsilon_0}{2} \int E^2 d\tau. \quad (2.45)$$